

Course Syllabus

Bellini College of Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity, and Computing
CRN 91997, Sec. 001, 3 Credit hours

Instructor	Raiyan Abdul Baten, Ph.D.	Term and year	Fall 2025
Email	rbaten@usf.edu	Time, place	TR 6:30 pm - 7:45 pm; CWY 107
Phone	585 200 8886	Modality	In-person
Office hours	Tue, 9:00 am - 12:00 pm	TA	Mohammad Ratul Mahjabin (mohammadratul@usf.edu)
Office	ENG 116	TA office hours	TR 2:00 pm - 3:30 pm (Teams link)

1. University Course Description

This course introduces students to ethical issues and professional responsibilities arising in the computer sciences. Students will develop ethical solutions to real-world problems and present them.

Note: This course is part of the University of South Florida's General Education Curriculum and is certified for Ethical Reasoning and Civic Engagement (ERCE). Students enrolled in this course will be asked to participate in the USF General Education assessment effort, which will involve submitting copies of writing assignments for review via Canvas.

2. Course Prerequisites

Majors Only, Senior Standing.

3. Student Learning Outcomes

Students will be able to:

1. Evaluate the impact of individual choices on local and global communities.
2. Communicate ideas and information to diverse audiences.
3. Demonstrate the ability to comprehend, express, and adapt to ideas based on others' perspectives.

4. Independently and accurately apply ethical perspectives and concepts to ethical questions or civic projects as appropriate and demonstrate the ability to consider the full implications of this application.
5. Demonstrate an ability to recognize ethical and professional responsibilities.
6. Communicate effectively with a range of audiences.
7. Recognize ethical and professional responsibilities in engineering situations and make informed judgments, which must consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and societal contexts.
8. Communicate effectively in a variety of professional contexts.
9. Recognize professional responsibilities and make informed judgments in computing practice based on legal and ethical principles.

4. Required Texts and/or Readings and Course Materials

Required readings will be made available through Canvas.

5. Grading scale

Grading Scale (%)	
90-100	A
80 - 89.99	B
70 - 79.99	C
60 - 69.99	D
0 - 59.99	F

6. Grade Categories and Weights

Assessment	Percent of Final Grade
End-of-topic quizzes	35%
Participation*	20%
Final exam	10%
Final project**	35%

*Participation activities will be determined at a future date and may, by default, comprise attendance-mandatory tasks.

**The Final Project (35% of the total grade) will comprise group and individual grade components.

7. General Education Statement

Note: This course is part of the University of South Florida's General Education Curriculum and is certified for Ethical Reasoning and Civic Engagement (ERCE). Students enrolled in this course will be asked to participate in the USF General Education assessment effort, which will involve submitting copies of writing assignments for review via Canvas.

8. Integration of This Course into Your Academic Experience

This course introduces students to ethical issues and professional responsibilities arising in the computer sciences. Students will develop ethical solutions to real-world problems and present them.

9. Disclaimer for Florida's "Campus Free Expression Act"

(A) pursuant to Florida's "Campus Free Expression Act," the university cannot shield students from ideas and opinions they may find uncomfortable, unwelcome, disagreeable, or offensive; and (B) any instructional discussions are intended to be objective.

It is fundamental to the University of South Florida's mission to support an environment where divergent ideas, theories, and philosophies can be openly exchanged and critically evaluated. Consistent with these principles, this course may involve discussion of ideas that you find uncomfortable, disagreeable, or even offensive. In the instructional setting, ideas are intended to be presented in an objective manner and not as an endorsement of what you should personally believe. Objective means that the idea(s) presented can be tested by critical peer review and rigorous debate, and that the idea(s) are supported by credible research. Not all ideas can be supported by objective methods or criteria. Regardless, you may decide that specific ideas are worthy of your personal belief. In this course, however, you may be asked to engage with complex ideas and demonstrate an understanding of them. **Understanding or engaging with an idea does not mean that you are required to believe it or agree with it.**

10. Standard University Policies

Policies about *Academic Integrity*, *Academic Grievance Procedure*, *Disability Access*, *Disruption to Academic Progress*, *Food and Housing Insecurity*, *Free Expression on Campus*, *Pregnancy or Related Conditions*, *Religious Observances*, *Sexual Misconduct/Sexual Harassment*, and *Academic Continuity* are governed by a central set of policies that apply to all classes at USF. These may be accessed at:

<https://www.usf.edu/provost/faculty/core-syllabus-policy-statements.aspx>

11. Course Policies: Grades

Professionalism: A critical component of this course's learning outcomes is demonstrated through professional behavior, both inside and outside of the classroom. **Any behavior that can be considered a violation of this, including unprofessional behavior demonstrated towards the professor or other students,** can be penalized in the form of course grade reductions at the discretion of the professor. Per university policy and classroom etiquette, mobile phones, iPods, etc., must be silenced during all classroom lectures. Those not heeding this rule will be asked to leave the classroom immediately to avoid disrupting the learning environment. Please arrive on time for all class meetings and leave after the class ends. Students who habitually disturb the class by talking, arriving late, leaving early, etc., may suffer a reduction in their final class grade.

Attendance and Make-Up Policy: Students are expected to attend classes. However, attendance will not be formally recorded nor directly graded. The quizzes and participation activities will, by default, take place *in person*, making attendance indirectly tied to these graded items.

If a student misses an in-person quiz or participation activity, there are two ways to get a makeup:

- (A) *Use a make-up token without providing any reasoning/documentation:* At the beginning of the semester, each student will have three (3) makeup tokens, each of which can be used for making up a missed quiz or a participation activity without having to provide any reason or documentation. However, the make-up must take place within a week of the original graded activity unless compelling situations demand otherwise. The instructor may or may not allow deviation from this 1-week requirement depending on whether he finds the justifications reasonable. Please email the instructor to use a token and to set a make-up time. No additional token will be provided after the three tokens are used.
- (B) *Submit documentation of extraordinary need:* If there is an extraordinary need for a makeup (e.g., jury duty, hospitalization, or attending university-sponsored events), the student must submit adequate documentation (e.g., verification of care letter) to the instructor *as soon as realistically possible* for consideration. The instructor reserves the right to determine which requisite materials constitute approval. If approved, no token will be used, and the makeup will be scheduled at the earliest reasonable time.

The Final Project will have group and individual grading components with specific deadlines. There will be no makeup or token usage for these deadlines. However, if an extraordinary situation arises that demands an extension (e.g., having jury duty, hospitalization, or attending university-sponsored events), the student(s) must submit adequate documentation (e.g., verification of care letter) to the instructor *as soon as realistically possible* for consideration.

Make-ups for the final exam will be decided as per the university's final exam policy.

First-day Attendance: The instructor will take attendance during the first lecture of the course to drop students who do not attend and who do not have an excused absence. Students who experience extenuating circumstances that are beyond their control and who are unable to attend the class must notify the instructor via email before the absence with appropriate documentation to request an excused absence. See relevant policy here: <https://usf.app.box.com/v/usfpolicy10-006>.

Extra Credit Policy: Extra credit may be given at the instructor's discretion for projects, quizzes, participation activities, and final exams that are extraordinary and go far beyond the requirements for full credit. This is entirely up to the instructor, and he reserves the right to refuse the awarding of extra credit for any reason whatsoever. At the time of this writing, no extra credit opportunities are planned.

Grades of "Incomplete": The current university policy concerning incomplete grades will be followed in this course.

Group Work Policy: The Final Project and the Participation Activities will, by default, have group components. Every member of the group will receive the same score in these group components unless it is obvious (in the judgment of the instructor) that one or more members contributed significantly more or less to the component. Instructions on group formation will be provided later.

In case of group conflict: If you have concerns about your group after it is formed (e.g., certain members are too difficult to work with, or they are not contributing, etc.), it is your responsibility to inform the instructor as soon as possible. Group conflicts will be dealt with on a case-by-case basis and may heavily penalize individual component scores.

Midterm Grades: This course does not have a midterm exam. However, per USF Policy, a midterm grade will be available in OASIS. It will reflect all graded activities/items up to that point.

Final Examinations Policy: All final exams will be scheduled in accordance with the University's final examination policy.

Regrade Policy: If you believe an error was made in grading your work, you may submit a regrade request *within a week of grade publication* with a detailed explanation of which items you think we marked incorrectly and why. Because we will examine your entire submission in detail, your grade can go up or down due to a regrade request.

12. Course Policies: Technology and Media

Canvas: This course will be offered via USF's learning management system (LMS), Canvas. Most announcements will be posted via Canvas. If you need help learning how to perform various tasks related to this course or other courses being offered in Canvas, please view the following

videos or consult the Canvas help guides. You may also contact USF's IT department at (813) 974-1222 or help@usf.edu.

Email: Email will be used heavily in this course; you are required to check your email frequently to stay informed about last-minute course changes. You are encouraged to contact the professor with course-related questions via email, and responses will be given as soon as reasonably possible. You must submit questions as early as possible since responses may take several days or more.

Laptop Usage: Laptops are generally allowed in class for note-taking only, but the instructor may occasionally disallow their use.

Phone Usage: Phone usage is generally disallowed during class time unless otherwise noted by the instructor.

Classroom Devices: Use of recording devices must adhere to the USF policies mentioned in the “Florida Statute 1004.097 Free Expression on Campus” section under the Standard University Policies: <https://www.usf.edu/provost/faculty/core-syllabus-policy-statements.aspx>.

TEAMS Recordings: Although the course will be primarily delivered in person, classes may move online under unusual circumstances (e.g., due to hurricanes). In those cases, software may be used to record live class lectures and discussions. As a student in this class, your participation in live class discussions will be recorded. These recordings will be made available only to students enrolled in the class to assist those who cannot attend the live session or to serve as a resource for those who would like to review the content that was presented. Students who prefer to participate via audio only will be allowed to disable their video camera so only audio will be captured. Please discuss this option with your instructor.

13. Course Policies: Student Expectations

Course Hero / Chegg / Other Cheating Policy: The [USF Policy on Academic Integrity](#) specifies that students may not use websites that enable cheating, such as by uploading or downloading material for this purpose. This does apply specifically to Chegg.com, CourseHero.com, OpenAI's ChatGPT (use of artificial intelligence to generate course-related work), and likewise – any use of these websites (including uploading proprietary materials designed exclusively for use with this course) constitutes a violation of the academic integrity policy.

Office Hour Policy: The office hours (or ‘Help Hours’) are there for your benefit. You can visit me during my office hours to revisit class materials, discuss your progress, or any relevant issues.

End-of-Semester Student Evaluations: All USF classes use an online system for students to provide feedback to the University regarding the course. These surveys will be made available at

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the end of the semester, and the University will notify you by email when the response window opens. Your participation is highly encouraged and valued.

The Writing Studio: The Writing Studio is a free resource for USF undergraduate and graduate students. At the Writing Studio, a trained writing consultant will work individually with you at any point in the writing process, from brainstorming to editing. Appointments are recommended but not required. For more information or to make an appointment, please visit <http://www.lib.usf.edu/writing/>, stop by LIB 2nd Floor, or call 813-974-8293.

Counseling Center Embedded Hours: The USF Counseling Center offers clinical services that are free, confidential, and available to all currently registered USF undergraduate and graduate students. For College of Engineering students, this Fall 2024 semester, we are also offering individual counseling onsite BY APPOINTMENT ONLY on Wednesdays and Thursdays from 2-5 pm at COE (Engineering Building II, Room ENB 201 (2nd Floor). View our website to complete new client forms, then call to make an appointment. Students can make an appointment at COE with embedded clinician Michelle Morton LMHC, by calling the Counseling Center at 813-974-2831 during business hours (8 am-5 pm).

Campus Emergencies: In the event of an emergency, it may be necessary for USF to suspend normal operations. During this time, USF may opt to continue delivery of instruction through methods that include but are not limited to Canvas, Elluminate, Skype, email messaging, and/or an alternate schedule. It's the responsibility of the student to monitor email and Canvas for course-specific communication, as well as the main USF, college, and department websites, emails, and MoBull messages for important general information.

14. Course Schedule (Tentative)

Note: The Schedule is subject to revision at any time before or during the course. You must check your email and Canvas regularly for updates to this schedule.

Important: The total number of quizzes and participation activities during the semester might be reduced (e.g., due to natural calamities or the instructor's travel schedule).

Keys: PA = participation activity; Q = quiz; Lx = Lectures on topic x

Week	Tuesday		Thursday	
Week 1 (8/26, 8/28)	L1: Ethics overview, codes of ethics		L1 cont.	
Week 2 (9/2, 9/4)	L2: Argumentation, how to argue	Quiz 1	L2 cont.	PA: topic 2
Week 3 (9/9, 9/11)	L3: Fallacies and biases	Quiz 2	L3 cont.	PA: topic 3
Week 4 (9/16, 9/18)	L4: Risk Analysis and CBA	Quiz 3	L4 cont.	PA: topic 4

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Week 5 (9/23, 9/25)	L5: Ethics Processes	Quiz 4	L5 cont.	PA: topic 5
Week 6 (9/30, 10/2)	L6: Whistleblowers, freedom of speech	Quiz 5	L6 cont.	PA: topic 6
Week 7 (10/7, 10/9)	L7: Encryption and security	Quiz 6	L7 cont.	PA: topic 7
Week 8 (10/14, 10/16)	L8: Privacy	Quiz 7	L8 cont.	PA: topic 8
Week 9 (10/21, 10/23)	L9: Intellectual Property	Quiz 8	L9 cont.	PA: topic 9
Week 10 (10/28, 10/30)	L10: Algorithmic bias, diversity, EEO Start the final project	Quiz 9	L10 cont.	PA: topic 10
Week 11 (11/4, 11/6)	L11: Misinformation and Social Media	Quiz 10	In-class project work	PA on project
Week 12 (11/11, 11/13)	No class, Veterans Day holiday		L11 cont. Final project check-in	PA: topic 11
Week 13 (11/18, 11/20)	L12: AI, automation, and human performance	Quiz 11	L12 cont.	PA: topic 12
Week 14 (11/25, 11/27)	Final exam review Submit the final project's written component (11/25, 11:59 pm)	Quiz 12	No class, Thanksgiving	
Week 15 (12/2, 12/4)	Submit final project video (12/1 MONDAY at 11:59 pm) In-class peer reviews of final projects		In-class peer reviews of final projects ** PA scored on Tu and Th participation (one PA)	
Week 16 (12/11)	Final Exam (12/11, 5:30pm - 7:30 pm, in the classroom) Revisions of the complete final project (video+report) are due at midnight on 12/11			

15. Important Dates to Remember

Note: All dates/assignments are tentative and may be changed later.

Thanksgiving Holiday	November 27 - 28, 2025
Final exam	Thursday, December 11, 5:30pm - 7:30 pm, at the regular classroom